

Biggest hummingbird

The Andean giant hummingbird is the largest hummingbird in the world. During the cold nights, its body temperature falls to just above freezing point. This helps the bird save energy, which it would otherwise use to keep its body warm.



Giant hummingbird
(*Patagona gigas*)
Length: up to 8.6 in
(22 cm)

Chiseling beak

The Andean flicker is a type of woodpecker. It uses its strong beak to chisel out a nesting hole in the spiny leaves of a Puya plant. Its feet are adapted for climbing, with two toes pointing forward and two backward.



Andean flicker
(*Colaptes rupicola*)
Length: up to 12.6 in
(32 cm)

Furry coat

Chinchillas live high up in the Andes and have soft, thick fur coats to keep out the cold. They are now rare animals, as humans have killed many to make coats from their fur. Chinchillas make their homes in holes and cracks among the rocks.



Chilean chinchilla (*Chinchilla lanigera*)
Body length: up to 9.5 in (24 cm)
Tail: up to 6.7 in (17 cm)

Changing spectacles

The white markings around the eyes of the spectacled bear make it look as if it is wearing glasses. These markings vary a lot, and each animal has different-shaped spectacles. At night it sleeps in a tree, where it builds a nest of sticks.



Spectacled bear (*Tremarctos ornatus*)
Height at shoulder: up to 2 ft 7 in (80 cm)
Body length: 6 ft 2 in (up to 1.9 m)



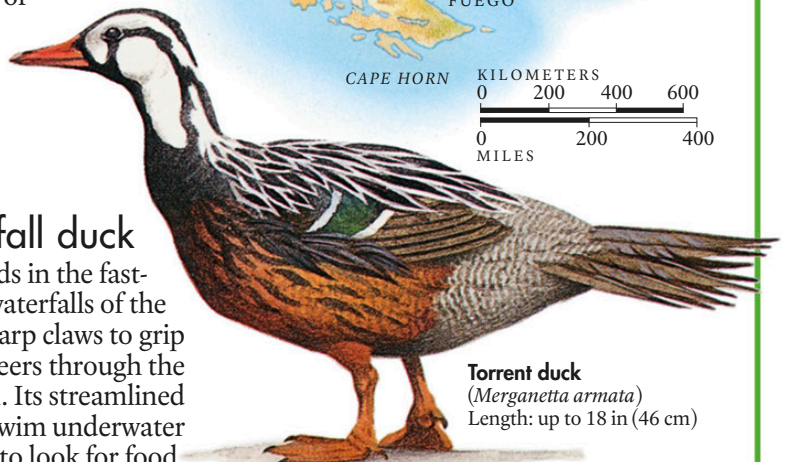
Alpaca (*Vicugna pacos*)
Height at shoulder: up to 3 ft (90 cm)

Shaggy camel

The alpaca is a relative of the camel. It has a shaggy coat of fine, soft hair that reaches almost to the ground. People use their woolly coats to make clothes. An alpaca's fleece weighs about 6.5 lbs (3 kg).

Waterfall duck

The torrent duck feeds in the fast-flowing streams and waterfalls of the Andes. It uses its sharp claws to grip slippery boulders and steers through the water with its stiff tail. Its streamlined body shape helps it swim underwater when it dives to look for food.



Torrent duck
(*Merganetta armata*)
Length: up to 18 in (46 cm)

